

VALENTINA GONZÁLEZ-ROSTANI

✉ gonzalez.rostani@usc.edu · 🏠 gonzalez-rostani.com · 📍 DMC 319, USC

ACADEMIC APPOINTMENTS

University of Southern California (USC) *Fall 2025–Present*
Assistant Professor, Department of Political Science and International Relations
Offer received in Fall 2023; start deferred to Fall 2025

Princeton University *2024–2025*
Postdoctoral Research Associate, Department of Politics.
Affiliated with the Mamdouha S. Bobst Center for Peace and Justice. PI Carles Boix.

AFFILIATIONS

Mobilization & Political Economy Program, NSF REU (Award # 2150250) *2023–Present*
Program Advisor

National System of Researchers (SNI), ANII, Uruguay *2025–Present*

EDUCATION

Ph.D. in Political Science, University of Pittsburgh *2024*
Dissertation: Political-Economic Polarization
Mancur Olson Best Dissertation Award in Political Economy, 2026
Committee: Jude Hays (chair), Michaël Aklin, Max Goplerud, Erica Owen

M.A. in Political Science, University of Pittsburgh *2021*

Master in Public Policy, Universidad Católica del Uruguay *2019*

Diploma of Specialization in Methods, Universidad Católica del Uruguay *2017*

B.A. in Accounting, Universidad de la República *2015*

PUBLICATIONS

“The Threat of Automation and Public Support for Environmental Regulation” with Liam Beiser-McGrath and Michaël Aklin. *Ecological Economics*, 2026

“Love of Variety? An Experimental Study of Heterogeneous Responses to Foreign Brands in the Marketplace” with Jude Hays. *Political Science Research and Methods*, 2026 (Conditionally Accepted)

“Sustaining Pathway Programs in the Social Sciences” with Chie Togami, Tania Ramirez, Fernando Tormos-Aponte and Yeneca Lee. *Perspectives on Undergraduate Research & Mentoring*, 2026 (Accepted)

“Elections, Right-wing Populism, and Political-Economic Polarization: The Role of Institutions and Political Outsiders.” *The Journal of Politics*, 2025

“Creating Pathways to Graduate Success: Reducing Barriers for Underrepresented Minority Students in the Social Sciences” with Tania Ramirez, Chie Togami et al. 2026. *Teaching Sociology* (Conditionally Accepted)

“Engaging Diversity: An Inclusive Approach to Undergraduate Mentorship in Mobilization and Political Economy” with Chie Togami, Mariely Lopez-Santana, Tania Ramirez, Fernando Tormos-Aponte, and Mayra Velez-Serrano. *PS: Political Science & Politics*, 2025

“Are Protests Contagious? The Dynamics of Temporal and Spatial Diffusion of Political Protests” with Jeffrey Nonnemacher. *Journal of Elections, Public Opinion & Parties*, 2025

“Engaged Robots, and Disengaged Workers: Automation and Political Apathy.” *Economics & Politics*, 2024

Recognized for being top viewed article - Wiley 2025

“Social Media vs. Surveys: A New Scalable Approach to Understanding Political Discourse” with Jose Incio and Guillermo Lezama. *Legislative Studies Quarterly*, 2024

Recognized for being top viewed article - Wiley 2025

“Moral and Economic Dimensions of Ideology” with Scott Morgenstern, Elias Chavarria, and Chen Chuang. *Legislative Studies Quarterly*, 2024

“Legislators’ Religiosity and Same-Sex Marriage in Latin America” with Scott Morgenstern. *Latin America Research Review*, 2023

BOOK CHAPTERS

“AI’s Economy and Its Political and Institutional Consequences” with Carles Boix, Michael Becher, and Daniel Stegmueller. In Nathaniel Persily and Joshua A. Tucker (ed). Artificial Intelligence, Politics, and Political Science. Forthcoming Cambridge University Press.

Failing Faster, Learning Better: Agentic AI and Empirical Social Science Research” with Charles Crabtree and Jae Yeon Kim. In Rohan Alexander (ed). Notes on the Future of Quantitative Social Science. Forthcoming CRC Press.

“Legislators’ Religiosity and Same-Sex Marriage in Latin America” with Scott Morgenstern. In Dennis P. Petri (ed). The Routledge Handbook of Religion and Politics in Latin America. Forthcoming Abingdon/New York: Routledge.

RESEARCH

Under Review

“From Automation to “Make It Great Again”: The Cultural Path to Right-Wing Populism” (R&R *Comparative Political Studies*)

“Immigration Shocks and Politicians’ Rhetoric: Evidence from The Venezuelan Migration Crisis” with Jose Incio and Guillermo Lezama (R&R *Legislative Studies Quarterly*)

“Can Taxing the Top 1% Unite Labor? Narrative Politics and Redistribution from the Super-Rich” with Santiago Lopez-Cariboni (R&R *Latin American Politics and Society*)

“The Political Economy of Automation and Fragmented Production in a Global Economy: Evidence from Mexico” with Carles Boix and Erica Owen

“Tracing AI Assistance and AI Agents in Survey Research” with Shir Raviv

“Which Populism, Where? Measuring Narrative Strategy at the Sentence Level” with Bree Bang-Jensen and Michael Colaresi

“Navigating Uncertainty: How Experience Shapes Perception and Politics in the AI Era” with Tobias Tober

“Automation from Abroad: External Technological Change and the Reorganization of Globalization”

Working Papers

“When Machines Manage: Workers’ Demands and Trade Union Responses to AI” with Paolo Agnolin

“Who Influences Whom? Analyzing the Interplay of Mainstream and Outsider Parties in Social Media Campaigns” with Claudia Salas Gimenez

“Multi-Level Models with Spatial and Temporal Dependence” with Jude Hays

“Automation narrows migration as an adjustment channel in the Mexico–U.S. corridor”

Selected Works in Progress

“Augmentation or Displacement? The Behavioral and Policy Implications of AI-Assisted Work” with Shir Raviv

“Collective Agreements in the Age of Artificial Intelligence” with Paolo Agnolin

“AI, Capital Concentration, and the Fate of Competition: Natural Monopolies, Antitrust, and the Politics of Big Tech Power” with Carles Boix

“The Untouchables: Why We Don’t Demand Taxes on Big Tech?” with Santiago Lopez-Cariboni

- “When Money Talks: Rethinking Income Redistribution and Political Inequality” with Jude Hays
- “Survey-grounded synthetic agents from high-dimensional opinion data” with Guillermo Lezama
- “A Networked Approach to Addressing Underrepresentation in the Social and Behavioral Sciences” with Fernando Tormos-Aponte, Chie Togami, Tania Ramirez, Mayra Velez-Serrano, Mariely Lopez-Santana, and Yeneca Lee.

SOFTWARE

`tscsdep`: Tools for analyzing country-year time-series-cross-sectional data with spatial and temporal dependence. Available on GitHub [Github/STADL](#) with Jude Hays, Scott Cook, and Robert Franzese.

SELECTED AWARDS & RESEARCH GRANTS

Mancur Olson Best Dissertation Award in Political Economy (APSA)	2026
Russell Sage Foundation , <i>Future of Work</i> [Invited to submit after LOI], \$200,000	2026
Schmidt Sciences , <i>AI at Work</i> \$10,000	2026
Schmidt Sciences , <i>AI at Work</i> [Invited to submit after LOI], \$200,000	2026
Russell Sage Foundation , <i>Behavioral Science and Decision Making in Context</i> [Invited to submit & R&R, Under review], \$200,000	2025
Center for International Studies RA Support, \$42,436	2026–2027
USC - POIR Research Award, \$9,999	2026
USC - POIR Travel Award, \$2,000	2025
Center for International Studies Research Award, \$10,000	2025–2026
Princeton University , Data Driven Social Science (w/ Agnolin) \$7,000	2025–2026
Center for International Studies RA Support, \$41,200	2025–2026
Princeton University , Research Award \$10,000	2024–2025
Andrew W. Mellon Predoctoral Fellow , ~ \$ 25,000	2023–2024
National Science Foundation	
PolMeth	2023, 2025
Mobilization and Political Economy, Summer Research Program	2023
EITM Summer School	2022
Georgia Tech’s Center for European Studies — J. Monnet, Erasmus+	2023
American Political Science Association	
Political Economy Rosenbluth Junior Scholar	2023
APSA Travel Grants	2023
Formal Theory Section Grant	2022
University of Pittsburgh	
European Studies Center Grant	2022–2023
Social Sciences Doctoral Dissertation (SSDD)	2022–2023
Arts & Sciences Summer Fellowships	2021, 2022, 2023

TALKS & GUEST LECTURES

U: Upcoming *C*: Invited but unable to attend due to visa issues

Invited Talks & Workshops

2026

Washington University in St.Louis, The Political Economy of Technological Change^U · Schmidt Sciences AI at Work · Yale University, AI for Social Science Research Methods · Bocconi University, AI and Society · University of Toronto, Applications of AI · University of Zurich, A New Politics of Artificial Intelligence? · Northeastern University, AI & Politics^U · University of Pittsburgh, Speaker series - NSF REU-Mobilization & Political Economy^U · Texas A&M University, Globalization Backlash · University of California, Riverside, Political Science Speaker Series · University of Washington, Severyns-Ravenholt Seminar · USC Center for International Studies, IR Seminar · USC Sol Price School of Public Policy, Political Institutions & Political Economy Seminar · APSA Labor Politics Group workshop^U

2025

Columbia University · IDB, Digital Technologies—Growth & Well-Being in Emerging Economies · Monash–Paris–Warwick–Zurich–CEPR, 10th Text-As-Data Workshop · MPE-NSF REU · NYU, Data Science Frontiers: Society and Politics · Nuffield College, Oxford^C · Penn State–Pitt IR Annual Workshop · Special Issue Workshop “The Future of Labor” · IBEI, Barcelona^C · University of Nebraska–Lincoln, Hendricks Symposium · UNESCO^C · University of Pennsylvania, Junior Scholars in IR · Universidad de la Republica^U · Yale University–ISPS

2024

Caltech CSSPP · Princeton University–Niehaus Center, IR Faculty Colloquium · Princeton University, Political Economy Colloquium · Yale University–MacMillan Center

2023

APSA Political Economy, Rosenbluth Junior Scholar Workshop · Boston University · Birmingham University · CIDE · Georgia Tech · GSIPE Workshop · MPE-NSF REU · UC Berkeley (ACES) · Universidad Católica del Uruguay · Universidad de Salamanca · University of Southern California · University of Strathclyde · University of Pittsburgh, Comparative Politics Seminar · Penn State–Pitt IR Annual Workshop · University of Zürich

2022

EITM Institute · Techno-Debate

2021

Universidad Católica del Uruguay · University of Pittsburgh

Conferences

APPAM (2025) · APSA (2022^C, 2023, 2024, 2026^U) · Environmental Politics & Governance (2022) · EPSA (2023) · EUSA (2022, 2023) · IPES (2022, 2024, 2025) · ISA (2025) · LACEA-LAMES (2024) · LASA (2021, 2023) · MPSA (2021–2025) · NABE Tech Economics Conference (2025) · PolMeth (2023, 2025, 2026^U) · LAPolMeth (2024, 2025^C)

TEACHING & MENTORING

U: Undergraduate *G*: Graduate

University of Southern California

Advanced Methodology: Text as Data^G

Fall 2025

Introduction to Data Analysis^U

Spring 2025

The Politics of International Trade^U

Spring 2026

Students — Committee Member / Mentor

Hugo Lopez Plascencia^U (UCR, MPE NSF-REU)

2026

Linton Lee^G (USC)

2026–Present

Claudia Salas Gimenez^G (USC)

2025–Present

Yana Demeshko^G (USC)

2025–2026

Paula Martinez^G (Udelar, Uruguay)

2025

PRE-PHD TEACHING & MENTORING

Mobilization and Political Economy, NSF REU^U

Instructor and Mentor

Summer 2023

Placed students from underrepresented backgrounds in grad programs.

Supervised 4 undergraduate research projects and Ph.D. applications.

University of Pittsburgh

Research Methods in Political Science^U

Instructor of Record

Summer 2022

Teaching Assistant

Fall 2021 & Spring 2022

Undergraduate and Graduate Student Mentoring

2022–2024

Supervised 4 undergraduate research assistants; mentored 6 first-year Ph.D. students.

Universidad de la República (Uruguay)

Teaching Assistantships^U

2014–2019

Labor Law and Social Security; Accounting I–III; Administration of Organizations; Housing Cooperatives Training.

Mentored 60+ first-generation undergraduate students

2013–2016

Training in Pedagogy	
Achievement in Pedagogy Badge, University of Pittsburgh	2021–2022
Faculty Development Practicum, University of Pittsburgh	Fall 2021
Faculty Development Course, Universidad de la República	Spring 2016

METHODS & POLITICAL ECONOMY TRAINING

Gen AI Intensive Course with Google	2025
Prompt engineering, embeddings, and generative AI agents.	
APSA Dissertation Workshop	2023
New Topics in European Politics, Kleine (LSE) & Obholzer (Leiden University).	
EITM Institute, UC Berkeley — NSF-sponsored Summer School	2022
Winter School in Methods, Universidad Católica del Uruguay	2016–2018
Bargaining using formal models, N. Bapat (UNC Chapel Hill)	
Methods for interpretation and analysis of RDD, S. Calonico (U of Miami)	
Case studies using process tracing, C. Rosell (UCU)	
IPSA-USP Summer School, Brazil	2018
Field research in PolSci, Melani Cammett (Harvard University)	
Advanced issues in quantitative methods, Bruno Cautres (Sciences Po)	

REVIEWER

American Journal of Political Science · The Journal of Politics · British Journal of Political Science · International Organization · Review of International Political Economy · Review of International Organizations · International Interactions (×2) · Comparative Politics · Legislative Studies Quarterly · European Political Science Review

SELECTED SERVICE

Political Science	
Discussant PolMeth	2026
Member, APSA Task Force on AI and Political Science	2025–Present
Chair, APPAM panel	2025
Grad Students in International Political Economy (GSIPE) team	2023–2024
Chair & discussant, EPSA, Political Economy of Labor panel	2023
Discussant, “Rethink Populism and Technocracy,” Pittsburgh	2022
Chair, LASA	2021
University of Southern California	
Convener, CIS International Relations Workshop series	2026–2027
Speaker at Workshop CIS, Research and Methods in the AI era	2026
Lecturer, Predoctoral Institute for First-Generation Scholars	2026
University of Pittsburgh	
Search Committee, Associate Professor — Structural Racism	2022–2023
Search Committee, Assistant Professor — Structural Racism	2022–2023
Search Committee, Postdoc with DEI focus	2022
Grad student rep, Diversity, Equity & Inclusion PolSci Committee	2020–2022
President of PolSci Graduate Students	2021–2022
Representative of PolSci at the GSO	2021–2022
Universidad de la República	
TA representative at University government	2019
Undergraduate student representative at University government	2013–2015
Member of advisory committees (e.g., study plan design)	2013–2015
Broad Audience	
Speaker, WS × Columbia University GD Fireside Talk Series	2025
Co-director, Razones y Personas social science diffusion blog	2024–Present
Speaker, IUSY series on the future of work	2023

RELEVANT SKILLS

Computational: Stata, R, Python **Survey:** Qualtrics **Text Annotation:** Inception
NLP: spaCy, Hugging Face Transformers, PyTorch, NLTK, Codex

Language: Spanish (native speaker)

OTHER WORK
EXPERIENCE

Academic Advisor to the Dean, FCEA Udelar	2017–2019
Advisor, National Congressman — economic, labor, and budget issues	2015–2017
KPMG, Tax Analyst	2015–2016
Political & Union Organizer	2011–2019

REFERENCES

Carles Boix

Robert Garrett Professor of Politics and
Public Affairs, Princeton University
cboix@princeton.edu

Erica Owen

Associate Professor, University of Pitts-
burgh
ericaowen@pitt.edu

Michaël Aklin

Chair of Policy & Sustainability Lab
Associate Professor, EPFL
michael.aklin@epfl.ch

Jude C. Hays

Professor, University of Pittsburgh
jch61@pitt.edu

Michael Colaresi

William S. Dietrich II Chair of Political Sci-
ence & Associate Vice Provost for Data
Science, University of Pittsburgh
mcolaresi@pitt.edu

Scott Morgenstern

Professor, University of Pittsburgh
smorgens@pitt.edu